



SRI LANKAN TEAM MEMBERS DURING THE CHAOS OF EVACUATION AT THE GADDAFI STADIUM; (FAR LEFT) ATTACKERS CAUGHT ON CAMERA

January 26. In fact, the Punjab's Chief Minister Shahbaz Sharif had himself attended meetings on the subject and issued strict instructions to ensure vVIP security for the visiting team. Subsequently, however, the Sharif government had been dissolved by Governor Salman Taseer after Sharif had been controversially disqualified from holding an elected post by the Supreme Court. Massive changes to the police and bureaucratic hierarchy in the wake of Governor's rule, and the political wheeling-dealing engaged by the governor to install a Peoples Party (PPP) government in Punjab, are now being blamed for distracting officialdom from the immediate security threat, a situation the terrorists apparently were able to exploit.

Whatever the reasons for the grave security lapse, and regardless of whether the pointed accusation against India carries merit or not, it is clear that relations between Pakistan and India do not seem about to return to any sort of normalcy in the immediate future. Although Pakistan has not officially accused India of complicity in the attacks yet, it looks entirely likely that it eventually will. The Government has already accused "those against friendship between Pakistan and Sri Lanka" of being behind the attacks. Also, many in the media have pointed out the long-standing strategic military relations between the two countries as well as claimed that Sri Lanka had taken up the tour offer despite attempts by the Indian Government to dissuade it. Also more importantly, the debacle highlights the growing sense of unease within Pakistan about a fast deteriorating political situation. The Lahore attacks have only added to a feeling within the country that the Government does not have what it takes to keep matters under control.

Alarm bells had already been ringing over the Government's acquiescence to militants in Swat last month, wherein the ruling secular coalition of

POLITICAL TURMOIL MAY SEE THE ARMY INTERVENE.

Even more troubling was evidence coming out in the media that the Government had ignored specific intelligence warnings by the Criminal Investigation Department about a possible attack, allegedly planned by the Research and Analysis Wing (RAW), the Indian intelligence agency, to target Sri Lankan players while they were being transported to and from the

cricket stadium. The warning was so timely—on January 22—and so specific that the fact that adequate measures were not taken to prevent the attack is being seen widely as an act of "criminal negligence". It is coming to light that the Punjab Government had indeed taken the warning seriously especially with regards to the one-dayer played by the Sri Lankans in Lahore on

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